

Building Bicycle Friendly Communities



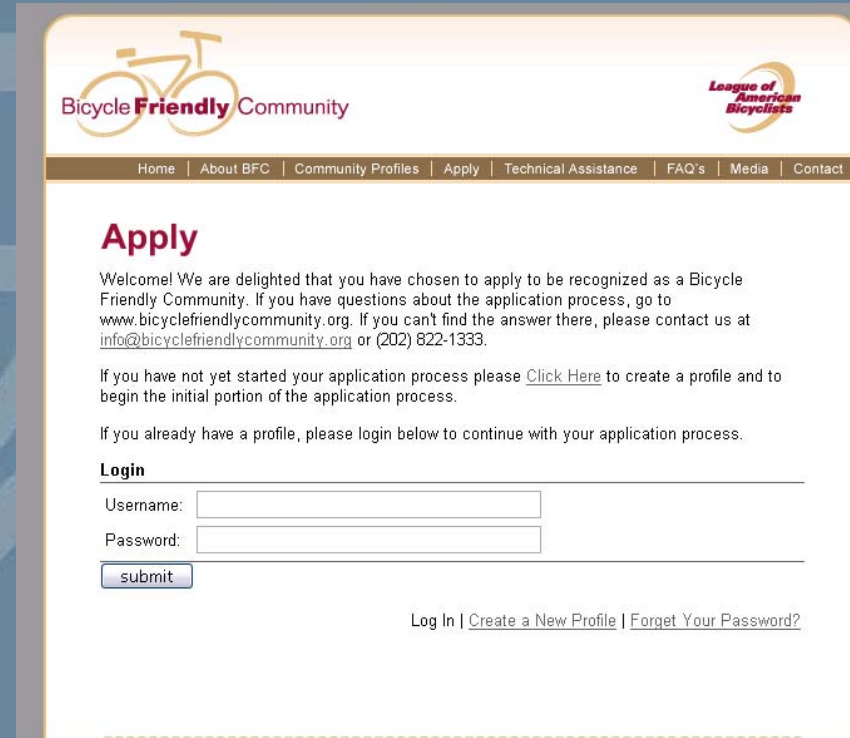
A Little History

- Started in 1996 with simple criteria
- Revised in 2002
- 4 Award levels
 - Platinum
 - Gold
 - Silver
 - Bronze



Applying

- Applications submitted online
- Review deadlines in March and August
- Application is divided into 2 sections
- Must be approved by city staff

A screenshot of the "Bicycle Friendly Community" application page. The page has a light orange header with a bicycle icon and the text "Bicycle Friendly Community". A navigation bar below the header contains links: Home, About BFC, Community Profiles, Apply, Technical Assistance, FAQ's, Media, and Contact. The main content area is titled "Apply" in red. It contains a welcome message, instructions on where to find more information, and a link to create a profile. Below this is a "Login" section with fields for "Username:" and "Password:", and a "submit" button. At the bottom right of the login section are links for "Log In", "Create a New Profile", and "Forgot Your Password?".

Bicycle Friendly Community

Home | About BFC | Community Profiles | Apply | Technical Assistance | FAQ's | Media | Contact

Apply

Welcome! We are delighted that you have chosen to apply to be recognized as a Bicycle Friendly Community. If you have questions about the application process, go to www.bicyclefriendlycommunity.org. If you can't find the answer there, please contact us at info@bicyclefriendlycommunity.org or (202) 822-1333.

If you have not yet started your application process please [Click Here](#) to create a profile and to begin the initial portion of the application process.

If you already have a profile, please login below to continue with your application process.

Login

Username:

Password:

[Log In](#) | [Create a New Profile](#) | [Forgot Your Password?](#)

Application Criteria

- Engineering
- Education
- Encouragement
- Evaluation & Planning
- Enforcement




The League of American Bicyclists
Bicycle Friendly Communities Campaign
www.bicyclefriendlycommunity.org

Part II is a checklist of the engineering, education, encouragement, enforcement, evaluation and planning efforts in your community. This comprehensive inquiry is designed to yield a holistic picture of your community's work to promote bicycling. To receive assistance for completing Part II, it is available at www.bicyclefriendlycommunity.org or by calling the League at 202-822-1333.

APPLICATION PART II

ENGINEERING

1. Do you have a policy that requires the accommodation of cyclists in all new road construction and reconstruction and resurfacing? Please include a copy of this legislation or policy.
2. Have you provided training for your engineers and planners on how to accommodate cyclists? Please describe. Is there a mechanism to provide training on an on-going basis?
3. How many bridges are in your community? How many are closed or inaccessible to cyclists? Of those accessible by bike, how many have shoulders, bike lanes, wide curb lanes, or sidewalks/walkways?
4. Are there bike racks or storage units at:

Schools	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Libraries	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Transit stations	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Recreation centers	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Government buildings	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Office buildings	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Retail centers	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
Public spaces and parks	(All)	(Most)	(Some)	(Few)	(None)
5. Are buses equipped with bike racks? (All) (Most) (Some) (Few) (None)

Application Review

- 250+ applications
- 103 recognized communities
- Reviewed by staff and external reviewer
- Feedback from local cyclists and advocates



And the Winners are...

- Designations in May and October
- Local and national press
- Award ceremony
- Renewals every four years



Designated Communities

- Platinum
 - Boulder, CO
 - Davis, CA
 - Portland, OR
- Gold
 - Corvallis, OR
 - Fort Collins, CO
 - Jackson/ Teton County, WY
 - Madison, WI
 - Palo Alto, CA
 - San Francisco, CA
 - Seattle, WA
 - Stanford, CA
 - Tucson/ Pima region, AZ
- Silver
 - Arlington, VA
 - Austin, TX
 - Bellingham, WA
 - Chicago, IL
 - Colorado Springs, CO
 - Durango, CO
 - Eugene, OR
 - Folsom, CA
 - Gainesville, FL
 - Minneapolis, MN
 - Missoula, MT
 - Olympia, WA
 - Presidio of San Francisco, CA
 - San Luis Obispo, CA
 - Santa Barbara, CA
 - Santa Cruz, CA
 - Scottsdale, AZ
 - Steamboat Springs, CO
 - Tempe, AZ
 - Wood River Valley, ID

Bronze Communities

Ada County, ID
Albuquerque, NM
Ann Arbor, MI
Arvada, CO
Ashland, OR
Auburn, AL
Beaverton, OR
Bend, OR
Billings, MT
Bloomington, IN
Boca Raton, FL
Brentwood, CA
Brunswick, ME
Burlington, VT
Carmel, IN
Carrboro, NC
Cary, NC
Chandler, AZ
Chattanooga, TN

Chico, CA
Claremont, CA
Columbia, SC
Denver, CO
Flagstaff, AZ
Gilbert, AZ
La Crosse, WI
Lawrence, KS
Lexington-Fayette County, KY
Liberty Lake, WA
Longmont, CO
Louisville, KY
Mesa, AZ
Milwaukee, WI
Mountain View, CA
New York, NY
Oceanside, CA
Orlando, FL
Park City, UT

Redmond, WA
Roseville, CA
Roswell, GA
Sacramento, CA
Salem, OR
Salt Lake City, UT
San Jose, CA
Santa Clarita, CA
Schaumburg, IL
Shawnee, KS
South Lake Tahoe, CA
South Sioux City, NE
Spartanburg, SC
St. Petersburg, FL
Sunnyvale, CA
Thousand Oaks, CA
Vancouver, WA
Washington, DC

Technical Assistance

- Great self-assessment tool
- Application assistance – “What do you mean by this?” or “Where can I find examples of good bike plans?”
- Non-applicants as well
- Workshops and Local Bike Summits
- Action Plan for Bicycle Friendly Communities

Benefits of the BFC Program



- Recognition
- Promotion
- Benchmarking
- Technical help
- Inspiration



Benefits of Bicycling...



...are about more
than just the
bicycle. Bicycling
is about:

Health
Wealth
Freedom

Health = Physical Activity



- Easy way to get 30 minutes of routine physical activity
- Reduces heart and lung disease, cancers, osteoporosis, diabetes
- Obesity epidemic is huge national, local problem

Health - Environment



Bike facilities serve multiple objectives

- Transportation
- Recreation
- Stormwater management
- Corridor, habitat preservation
- Air quality



Govt. Finances = Savings



Trails: \$1 million per mile

Bike lanes: \$5,000 a mile

**\$100 parks 2 bikes, \$40,000
garages 1 car**



**20 bike cops = 1 police
cruiser**

Local Economy = \$ales

- **Bicycle tourism and rides are big business**
 - Bicycle vacations #3 outdoor vacation activity in US
 - La Route Verte (Can) generates \$100 million
 - NCDOT reports 9-1 return on investment for Outer Banks bike improvements



Tourism \$

Tucson, AZ



“This type of recognition for the region enhances Tucson’s image as a great destination for bicyclists and outdoor enthusiasts. “

“We are proud of the gold award, and we will continue to improve in the future”

-Mayor Bob Walkup

Local Economy = \$ales

- “More than 80% of (Portland) businesses surveyed emphatically state that Portland’s reputation for being a bicycle friendly city is good for their business.”

Portland’s bicycle-related industry is worth \$90 million to the regional economy and accounts for 800 jobs. -- A 40% increase since 2006

source: Portland Online

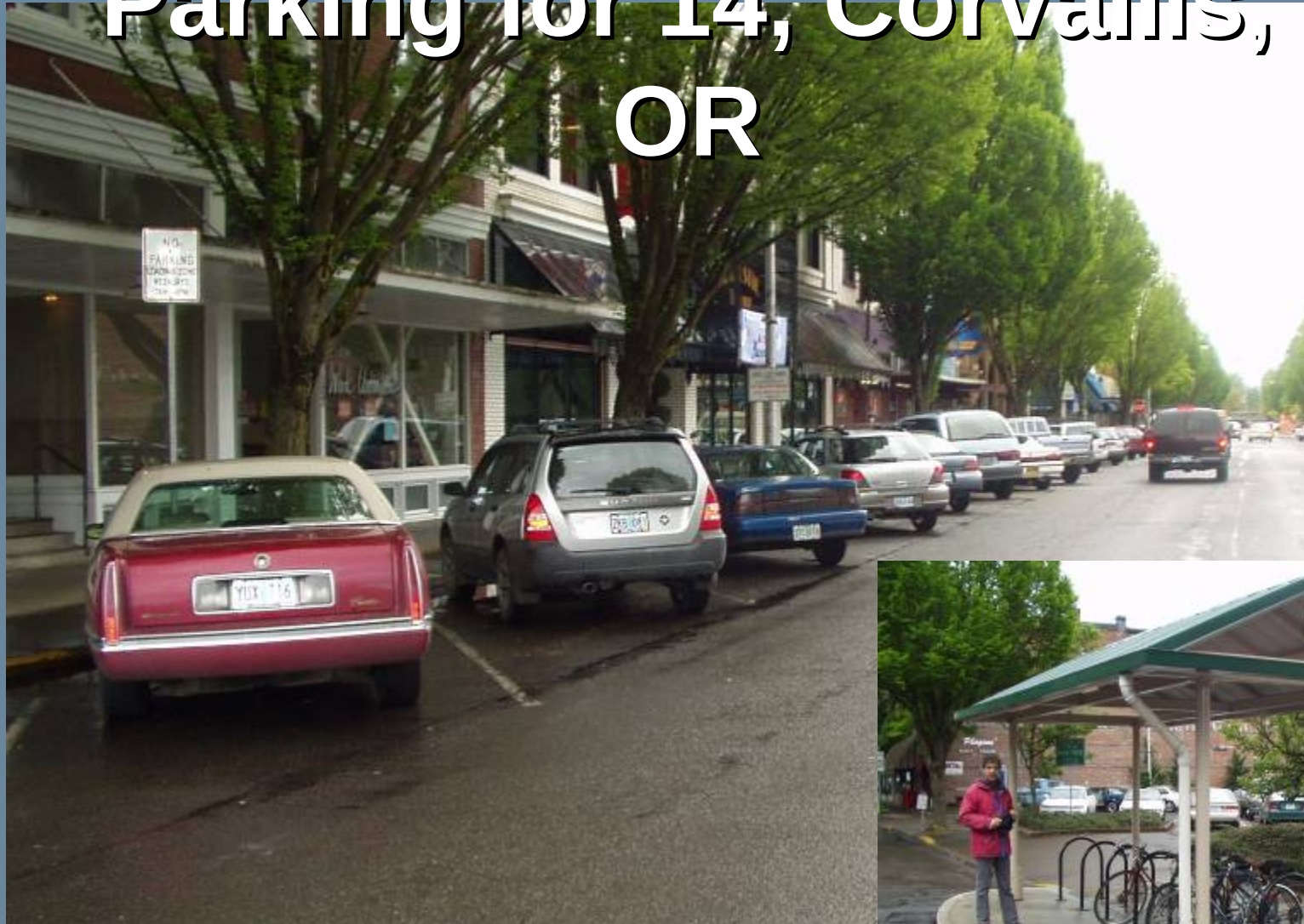


Use of Roads = \$pace



Parking for 14, Corvallis, OR

**League of
American
Bicyclists**



Quality of Life = Economic Development



- Home buyers want quality of life
- Businesses want QOL for employees
- Bicycling and walking are indicator species

Equity = Freedom



- 1/3 of population can't drive
- Bike serves all ages and incomes
- Increases accessibility of transit

Congestion Relief = Freedom



- 40% of trips 2 miles or less; nearly 90% are made by car.
- 28% of trips one mile or less; 67% made by car
- 20% of trips in a.m. rush are school based



Energy Independence = Freedom

- Most energy-efficient mode of travel
- Can reduce motor pool/fleet costs
- With gas at \$100 a barrel and \$3 a gallon, looks better than ever!



Bicycling is a Solution...

- ...Not a problem
- Can help solve many local issues
- Powerful public policy reasons for improving conditions for bicycling, making it safer.

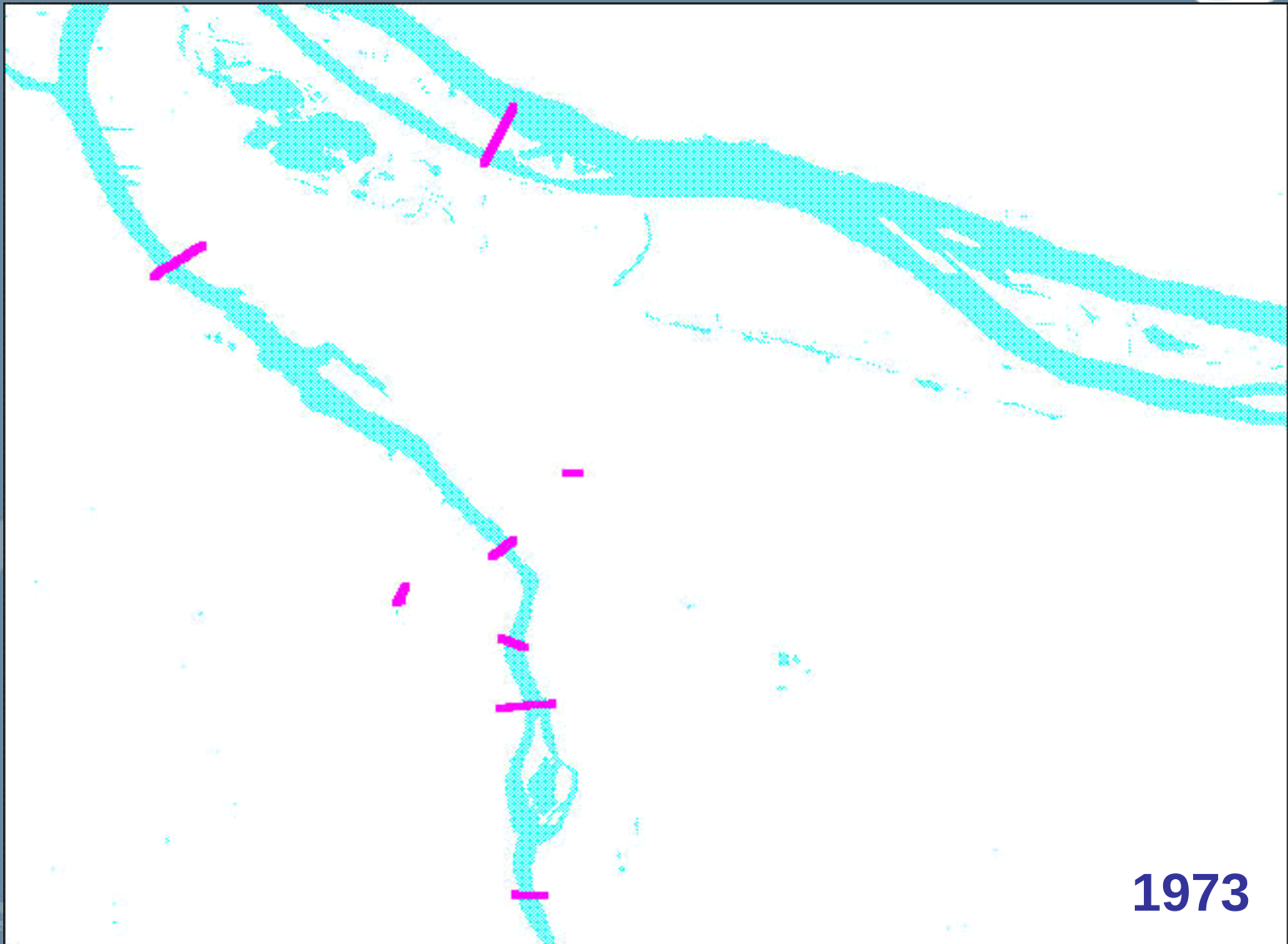


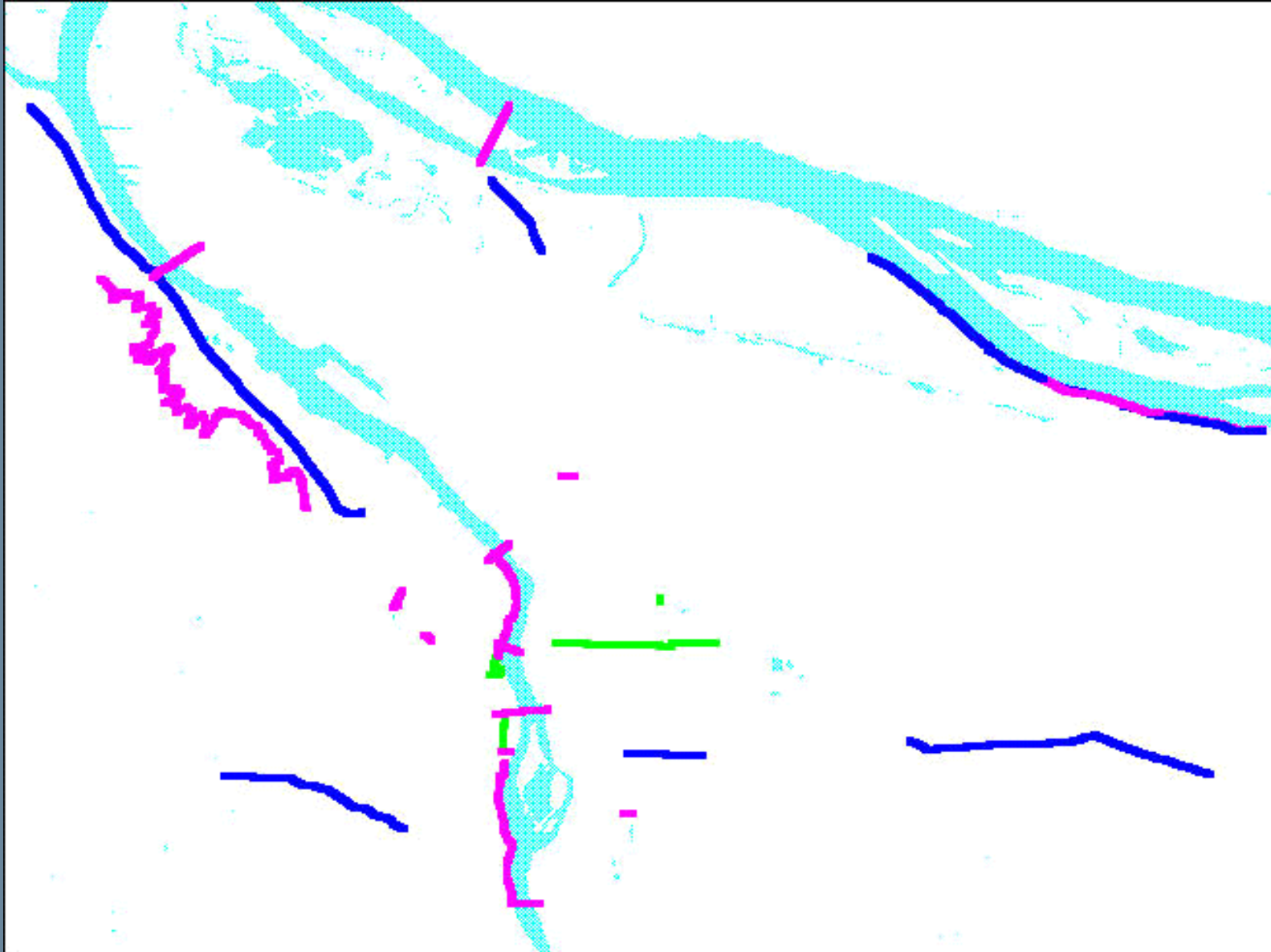
Portland: Case Study



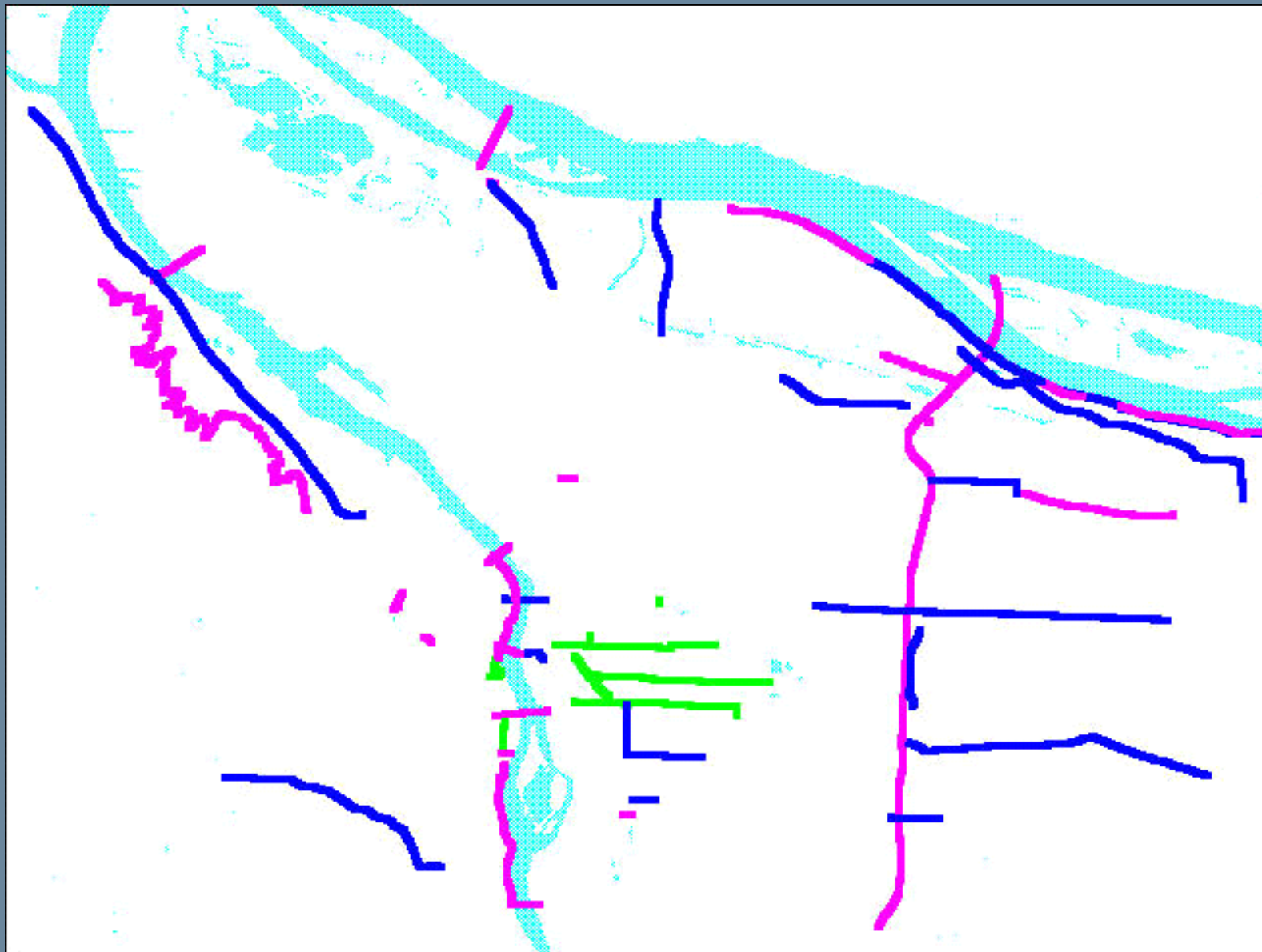
Developing the Bikeway Network

League of
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Bicyclists

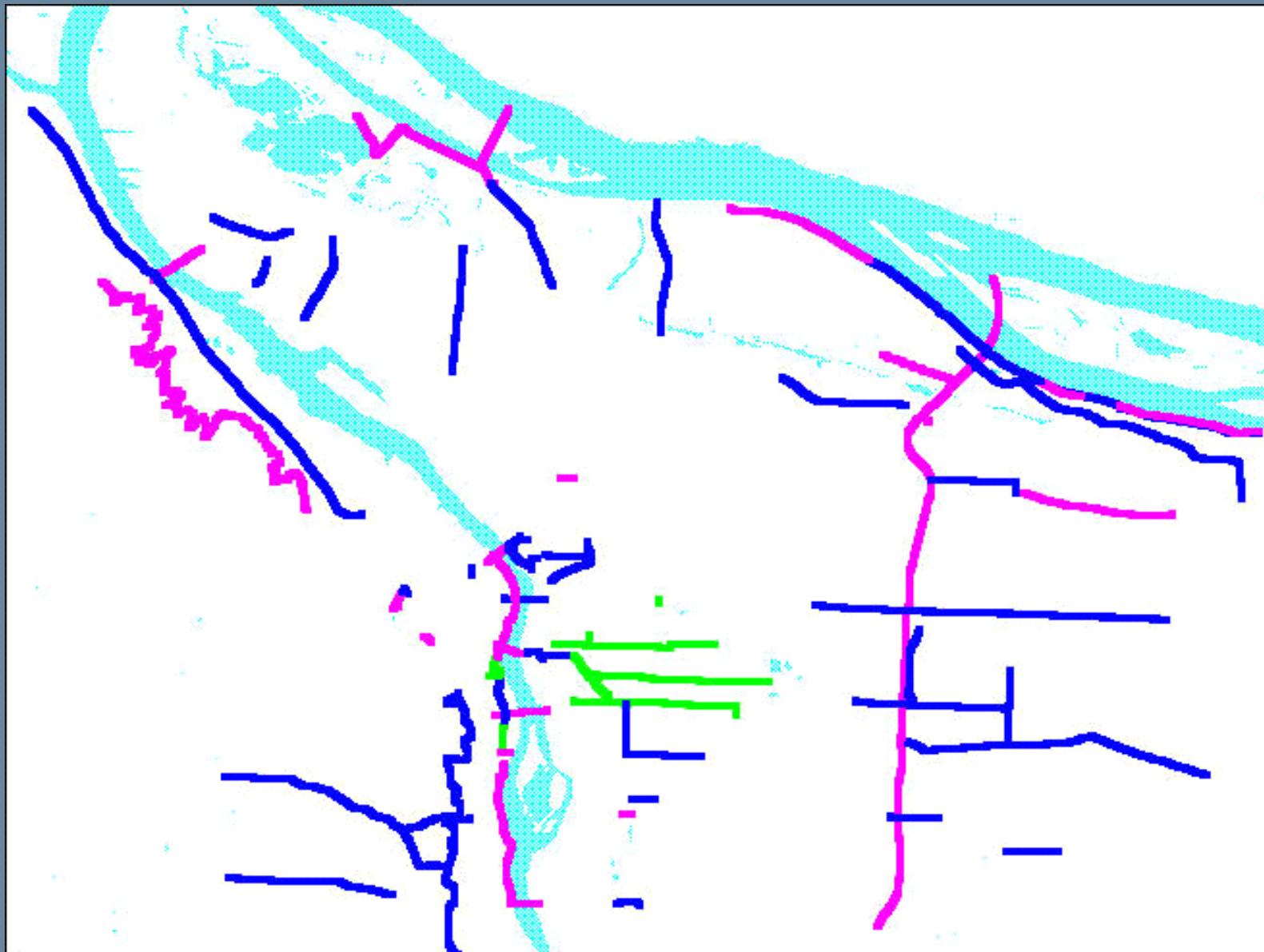




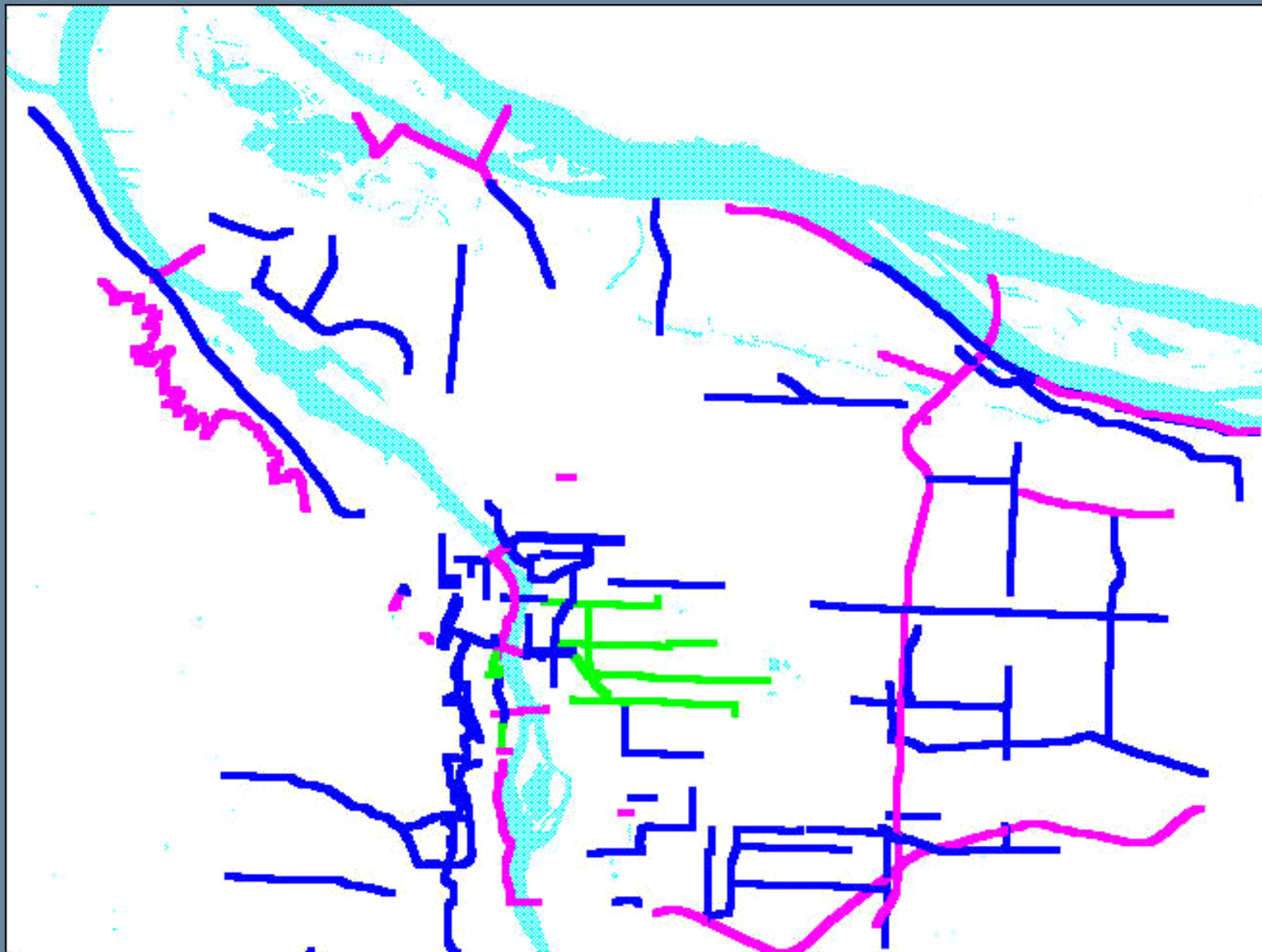
1983



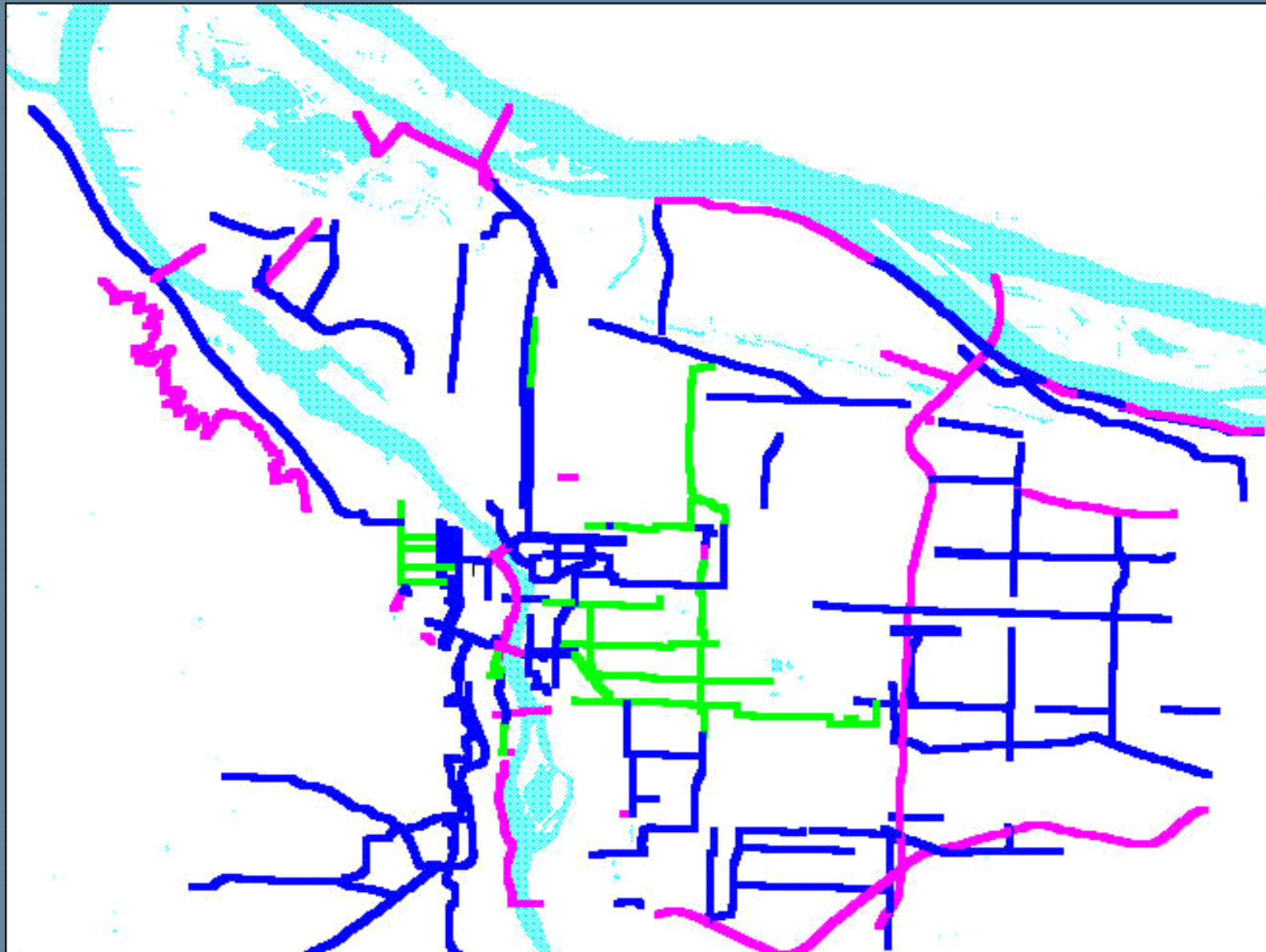
1993



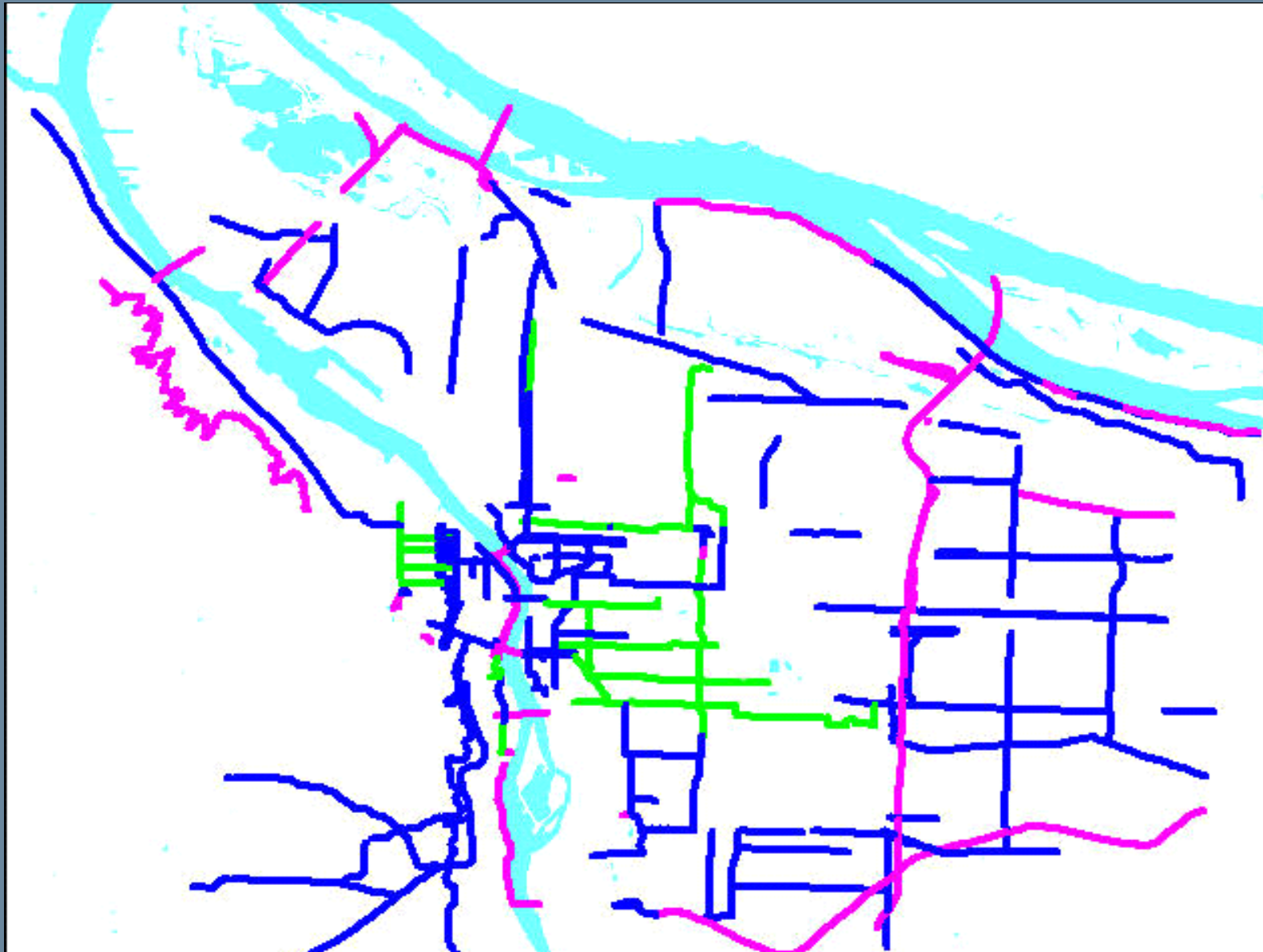
1996



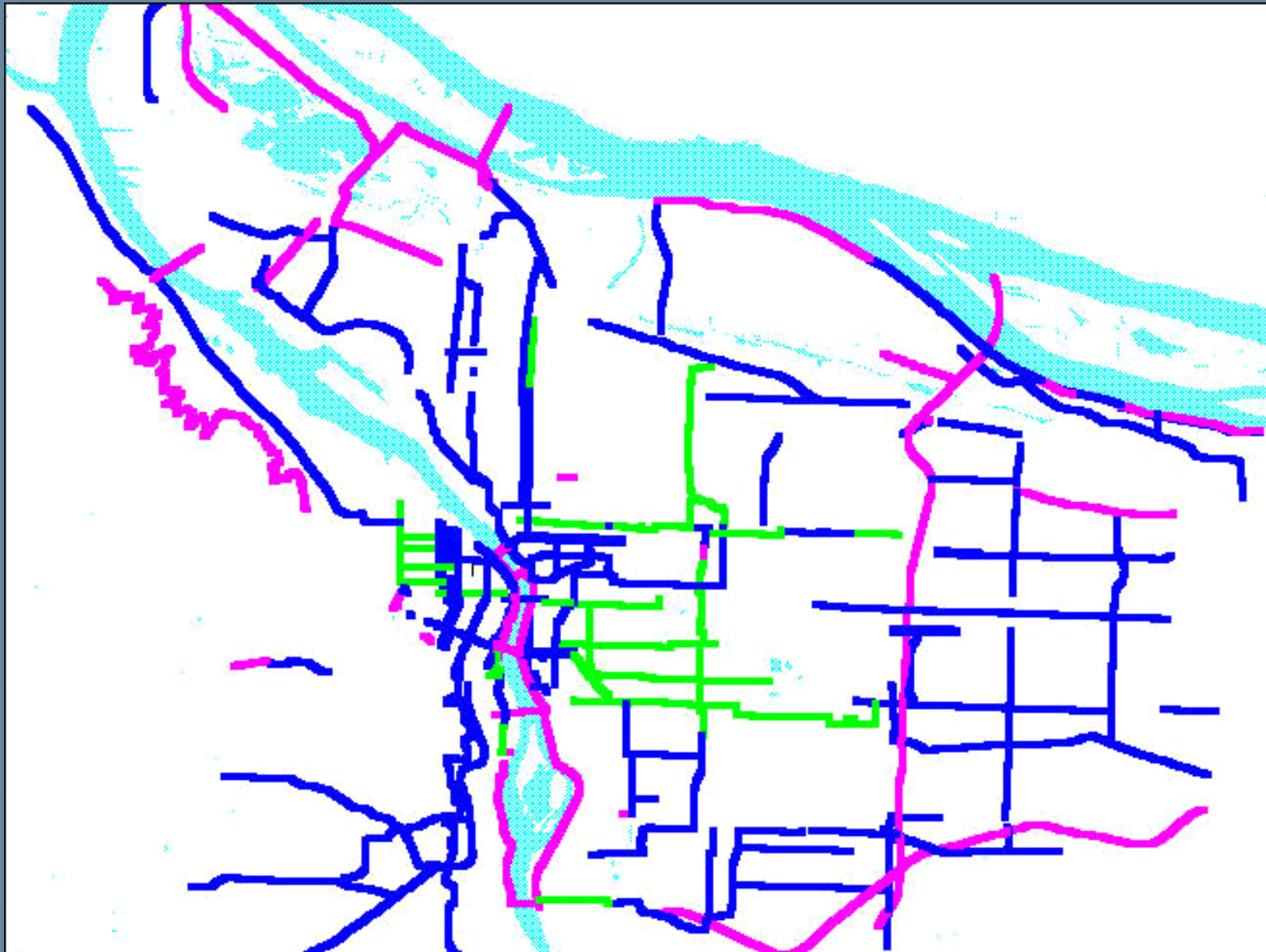
1998



2000



2001



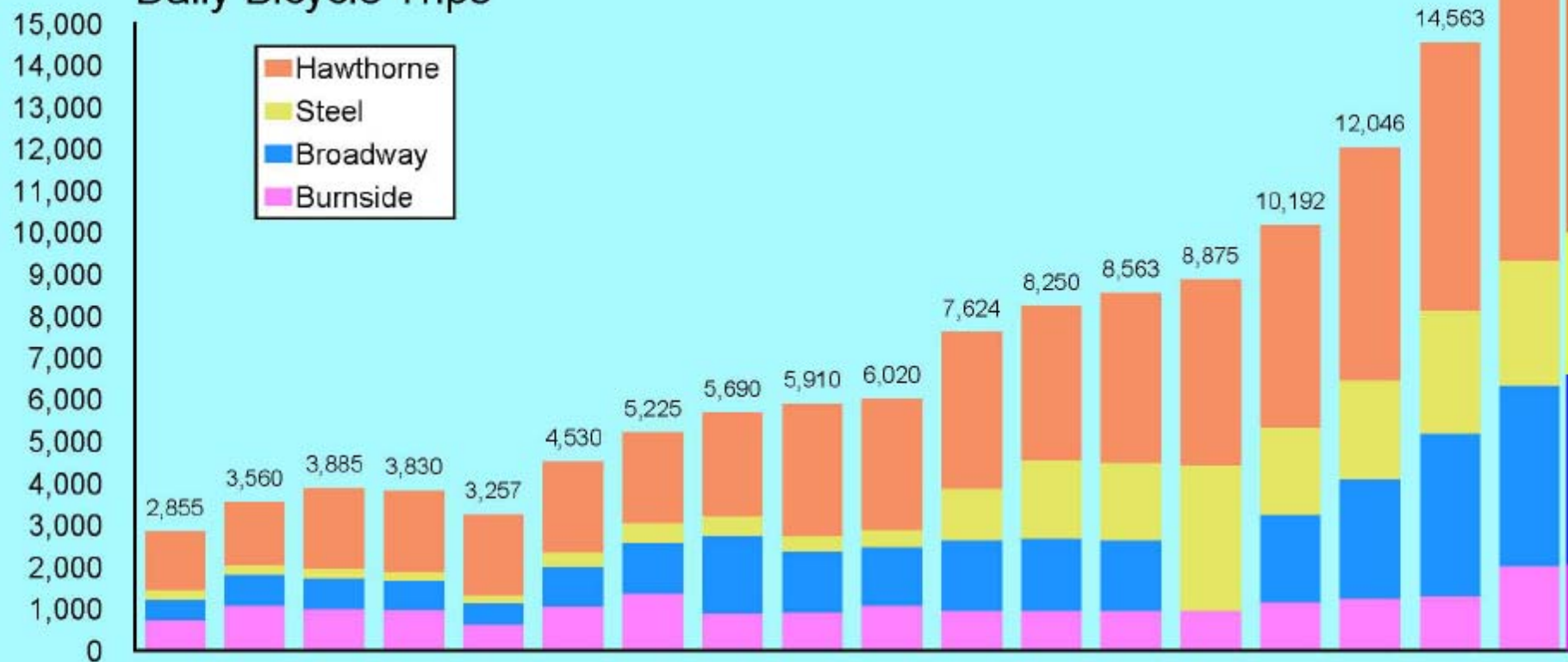
2003

Average Daily Bicycle Traffic

4 Main Willamette River Bicycle Bridges

2008
Peak:
(18,112)

Daily Bicycle Trips



	Before 1992	1992	1993	1994	1995	1996	1997	1998	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008
Hawthorne	1,390	1,500	1,920	1,940	1,910	2,165	2,170	2,471	3,154	3,125	3,729	3,682	4,055	4,428	4,829	5,557	6,423	7,379
Steel	230	230	220	220	200	350	475	460	360	410	1,250	1,891	1,860	3,482	2,112	2,373	2,943	2,982
Broadway	495	755	735	690	527	950	1,205	1,854	1,476	1,405	1,680	1,712	1,683	*	2,081	2,856	3,872	4,315
Burnside	740	1,075	1,010	980	620	1,065	1,375	905	920	1,080	965	965	965	965	1,170	1,260	1,325	2,035

Year

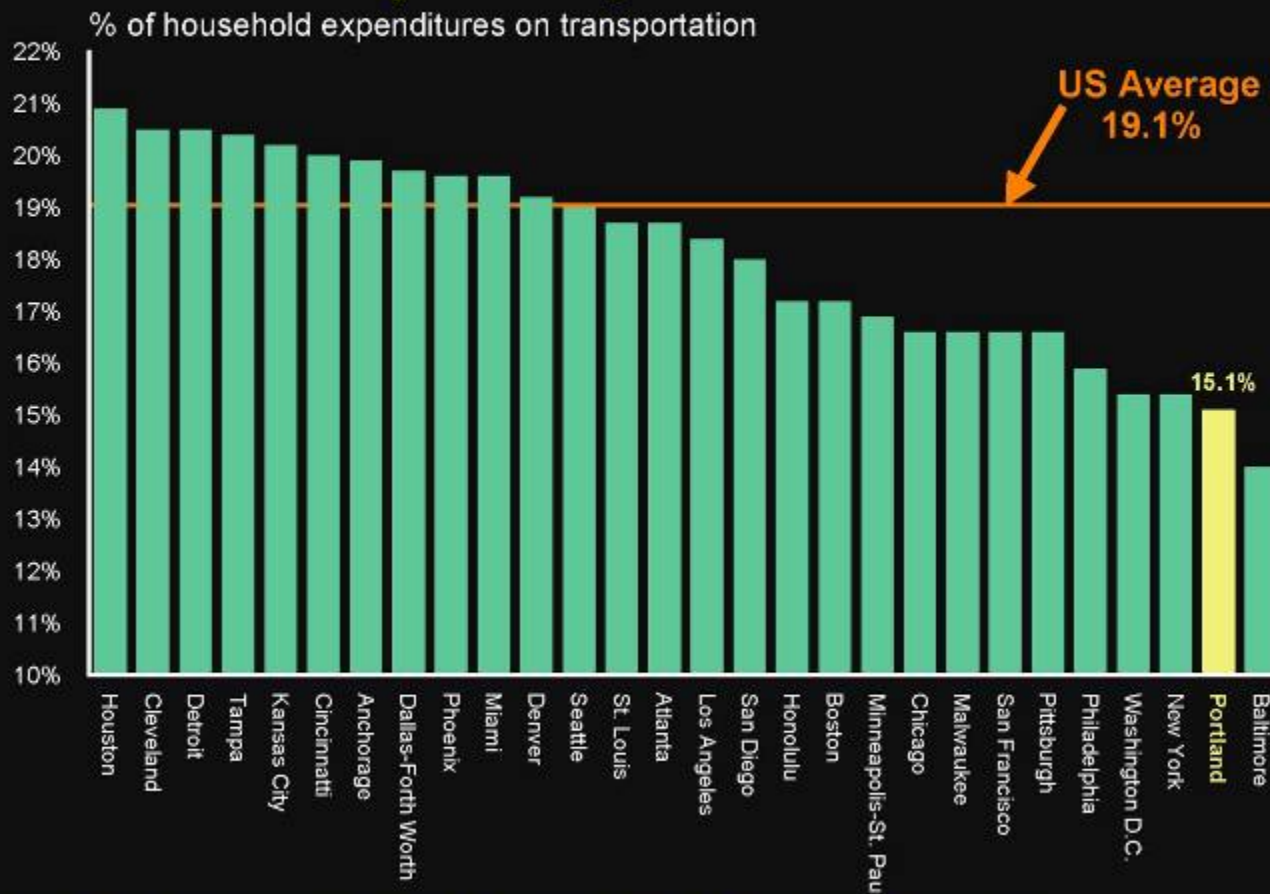
Based on either 24-hour hose counts or extrapolated from 4-6 pm counts

* Broadway Bridge closed for construction during time of count.

Portlanders Save Money On Transportation



2003 Household Expenditures on Transportation by Metropolitan Area



Source: Center for Neighborhood Technology and Surface Transportation Policy Project, "Driven to Spend: Pumping Dollars out of Our Households and Communities," as reported in Peak Oil Task Force Report, City of Portland, March 2007

Portland: Key Numbers

- Population 530,000, 1.6% journeys to work by bike (2000) – 3.9% (2007)
- Metro area 1.9 million, 0.8% bike to work
- City bicycle network of 260 miles
- Bicycling to work doubled 1990-2000 (U.S. Census)
- Crash # remained steady; rate fell

Inspiring Change: Louisville

Pop. 1 million. 0.2% bike to work.

Mayor's Metro Louisville Bike Summit (Feb. 05) due to unhealthy populace, uncompetitive quality of life.

Among worst cities in the nation for participation in physical activity



Goal to be Bronze BFC by 2008, Gold by 2014

Louisville

Since Feb. 05

- Raised \$53 million for 21st Century Parks trail initiative from local donors, SAFETEA-LU
- Improved neighborhood access and connectivity through bike/pedestrian facilities
- Striped first 8 miles of downtown bike lanes
- Mayor hosted Memorial and Labor Day rides
- \$20,000 grant for bike education classes, LCI training in 2006
- Adopted complete streets policy in 2008



Mayor received Bronze award at 2007 National Bike Summit – two years ahead of schedule!

Minneapolis

- Nearly doubled bicycle mode-share since 2000
 - Journey to work by bike – 1.89% (2000)
 - 3.8% (2007)
- Started local advocacy group
- Bicycling ambassadors providing bicycling education and encouragement
- Mayor Rybak's support
- Over 200 miles of bikeways
- Downtown Bikestation on greenway
- Paths plowed first



Carmel, Ind



City of 70,000 with 0.1% journey to work

BFC application in 2003 rejected. Re-applied each year

- 2004 first bike lanes striped (2 miles)
- Community bike ride started with 1,000 riders in '04, grew to 2,000 in '05
- Passed bike parking ordinance 2005
- Hosted LCI training 2006
- Approved \$6.3 million bond funding, local match for trails
- Hired bike coordinator; improved trail/roadway intersections; promoted trail use for special events, community activities

Awarded Bronze BFC in September 2006.

What Do BFC's Have?



- Commitment to action
 - Action Plan
- Targets, measures
- Network of all facilities
 - Complete Streets policy
- Breadth of programs
 - The Five E's
- People riding bikes!



Campaign Partners



www.bicyclefriendlycommunity.org